

# **Certificate Distribution Ceremony for Empowering Persons with Locomotor Disabilities through Assistive Sewing Technology (Under DST-SEED TIDE Skill Development Programme)**

The **Department of Fashion Technology (FT)** and the **Sona Centre for Social Responsibility Initiatives (CSRI)**, jointly organized the Certificate Distribution Ceremony for the differently abled beneficiaries who successfully completed the DST-SEED TIDE Project – *Promoting Independence and Empowerment for Locomotor Disabled Individuals through Assistive Sewing Technology* on Monday, 29 June 2026, at the MBA Conference Hall, Sona College of Technology, Salem. The event celebrated the successful completion of the training programme of 50 beneficiaries, empowering them with assistive sewing technology, enhanced vocational skills, and renewed confidence to pursue independent livelihoods, entrepreneurship, and financial self-sufficiency, reinforcing Sona College of Technology's commitment to inclusive innovation and social empowerment.

The programme commenced with a prayer song by the Sona Choir, followed by the Welcome address delivered by **Dr. K. Mani, Associate Professor (Dept of FT)**. He expressed his gratitude to all the dignitaries and attendees for their presence and support in making the programme a meaningful celebration of innovation, inclusion, and empowerment.

## **Project Overview and Innovation Highlights**

**Dr. D. Raja, Professor and Head, Department of Fashion Technology**, shared the journey of developing the assistive sewing technology under the DST-SEED TIDE project. He explained that the innovation was developed through continuous interaction with persons with locomotor disabilities, ensuring that it addressed their real-life needs and promoted greater independence and livelihood opportunities. He highlighted the successful implementation of the project through the collective efforts of the Department of Fashion Technology and the Sona Centre for Social Responsibility Initiatives (CSRI), acknowledging CSRI's valuable support in identifying and mobilizing the beneficiaries.

He emphasized the specially designed sensor-enabled tailoring machine developed for differently abled individuals, explaining how it enhances safety, ease of operation, and confidence while tailoring. Congratulating the beneficiaries on successfully completing the training



programme, he encouraged them to utilize the technology and skills acquired to achieve self-reliance and sustainable livelihoods. He also expressed his heartfelt gratitude to the Principal for his visionary leadership, continuous guidance, and unwavering support, which were instrumental in the successful execution of the project and in fostering innovations that create a lasting societal impact.

### **Special Address by the Principal**



In his special address, **Prof. Dr. S.R.R. Senthilkumar, Principal, Sona College of Technology**, stressed that the true purpose of research is to improve lives by translating innovation into meaningful societal impact. He stated that innovations should extend beyond laboratories and commercialization to benefit grassroots communities, particularly vulnerable sections of society. Highlighting Sona's

research ecosystem, he noted that the institution is committed to transforming research into sustainable livelihood opportunities. He also appreciated the role of the Sona Centre for Social Responsibility Initiatives (CSRI) in connecting research, government programmes, industry, and the community, enabling innovative technologies to reach the intended beneficiaries.

Concluding his address, he inspired the beneficiaries by recalling the vision of Dr A. P. J. Abdul Kalam, encouraging them to dream big and work towards achieving their aspirations.

He assured them of Sona College of Technology's continuous guidance and support in their journey towards self-reliance, entrepreneurship, and a better future.

## Empowering Persons with Disabilities through Inclusive Innovation



**Dr. Amita Bisare, State President, National Federation Human Rights Council, Chhattisgarh, and President, Salem Steel Ladies Circle, Salem** praised Sona College of Technology for its commitment to developing innovative technologies

that create meaningful change in the lives of persons with disabilities. She noted that initiatives such as the DST-SEED TIDE project reflect the true purpose of innovation—empowering individuals with the skills, confidence, and opportunities to lead independent lives. She encouraged the beneficiaries to embrace the training and technology as a pathway to self-reliance and entrepreneurship, while urging educational institutions to continue creating inclusive solutions that inspire hope, dignity, and equal opportunities for all.



As a token of love, the Chief Guest was felicitated with *The Sona Story*, the biography of Sri C. Valliappa, Chairman of Sona Institutions

The gesture reflected the institution's values and its dedication to fostering meaningful partnerships for community development. Ramesh of Anbalayam Trust was also honoured in recognition of his dedicated efforts in identifying and mobilising differently abled beneficiaries, whose support played a significant role in the successful implementation of the programme.

## Beneficiary Interaction

The beneficiaries interacted with the Chief Guests and Principal and shared their experiences of the DST-SEED TIDE project. They expressed their gratitude for the opportunity to receive hands-on training using the sensor-enabled tailoring machine, stating that it had enhanced their confidence and inspired them to pursue self-employment. They also shared their aspirations for employment and further skill development, seeking continued guidance and support to strengthen their livelihood opportunities. The Principal encouraged them to remain confident in their abilities and assured them of the institution's continued support in their journey towards self-reliance. The beneficiaries thanked Sona College of Technology for transforming their aspirations into opportunities and expressed their hope that many more differently abled individuals would benefit from the initiative.



## Certificate Distribution Ceremony



The certificate distribution ceremony marked the highlight of the programme, with beneficiaries receiving certificates in recognition of their successful completion of the training. The certificates were presented by the Chief Guest, **Dr. Amita Bisare, along with Revathi Varatharajan, Vice-President of the Salem Steel Ladies Circle, Anamika Maini, Joint Secretary of the organisation**, and the Principal of Sona College of Technology. The ceremony celebrated the beneficiaries' dedication, perseverance, and achievement, marking an important step towards self-reliance and economic independence while inspiring them to pursue greater opportunities with confidence and dignity.

The programme concluded on a positive note, reaffirming the commitment of the Department of Fashion Technology and the Sona Centre for Social Responsibility Initiatives (CSRI) to empowering persons with disabilities through inclusive skill development and assistive technology. Building on the success of the initiative, the institution will continue to mobilise support through CSR partnerships, philanthropic organisations, government welfare schemes, and other funding avenues to manufacture and provide assistive sewing machines to the trained beneficiaries. This sustained effort reflects Sona Institutions' commitment to transforming research into community-centred solutions that promote accessibility, self-reliance, and dignity while creating lasting social impact.

